

TRANSPARENCY, RTI AND INFORMATION SHARING

INFORMATION-GOVERNANCE DISTINCTION MAP → RTI SCOPE AND RIGHTS-HOLDER → SECTION 4 PROACTIVE-DISCLOSURE ENGINE → SECTIONS 6 AND 7 → SECTION 8 EXEMPTION AND → SEVERABILITY AND THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g1 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

INFORMATION-GOVERNANCE DISTINCTION MAP

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CENTRAL FOCUS

1. INFORMATION-GOVERNANCE DISTINCTION MAP

[1] TRANSPARENCY

SYSTEMIC VISIBILITY

[2] DISCLOSURE

PARTICULAR RELEASE

[3] SHARING

CENTRAL FOCUS

1. Information-governance distinction map

[1] Transparency: systemic visibility

[2] Disclosure: particular release

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 1. Information-governance distinction map
- [1] Transparency: systemic visibility
- [2] Disclosure: particular release

MECHANISM

- [3] Sharing: purpose-bound exchange
- [4] Open data: reusable datasets
- [5] Privacy: dignity and control
- [6] Accountability: answerability

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Forum supplies correction
- [8] Law sets legitimate limits
- VERDICT → Moving information is not identical to making power accountable.
- ANSWER USE → Use to define the topic and prevent synonym traps.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Moving information is not identical to making power accountable.

01

STAGE 01

RTI SCOPE AND RIGHTS-HOLDER ROUTE

RTI SCOPE AND RIGHTS-HOLDER ROUTE

CENTRAL FOCUS

2. RTI SCOPE AND RIGHTS-HOLDER ROUTE

[1] SECTION 3

CITIZEN'S RIGHT

[2] IDENTIFY PUBLIC AUTHORITY

[3] LOCATE HELD OR CONTROLLED RECORD

[4] INCLUDE LAW-ACCESSIBLE PRIVATE DATA

CENTRAL FOCUS

2. RTI scope and rights-holder route

[1] Section 3: citizen's right

[2] Identify public authority

[3] Locate held or controlled record

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 2. RTI scope and rights-holder route
- [1] Section 3: citizen's right
- [2] Identify public authority

MECHANISM

- [3] Locate held or controlled record
- [4] Include law-accessible private data
- [5] Do not demand new opinion
- [6] Applicant need not give reasons

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Assist persons needing help
- [8] Apply exemptions only afterward
- VERDICT → RTI opens existing recorded information; it does not compel fresh intellectual creation.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Sections 2, 3 and 6 answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → RTI opens existing recorded information; it does not compel fresh intellectual creation.

02

STAGE 02

SECTION 4 PROACTIVE-DISCLOSURE ENGINE

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CENTRAL FOCUS

3. SECTION 4 PROACTIVE-DISCLOSURE ENGINE

[1] CATALOGUE AND INDEX RECORDS

[2] COMPUTERISE APPROPRIATE RECORDS

[3] PUBLISH ORGANISATION AND DUTIES

[4] PUBLISH NORMS AND DECISION PROCESS

[5] PUBLISH BUDGET AND PROGRAMMES

CENTRAL FOCUS

3. Section 4 proactive-disclosure engine

[1] Catalogue and index records

[2] Computerise appropriate records

[3] Publish organisation and duties

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 3. Section 4 proactive-disclosure engine
- [1] Catalogue and index records
- [2] Computerise appropriate records

MECHANISM

- [3] Publish organisation and duties
- [4] Publish norms and decision process
- [5] Publish budget and programmes
- [6] Publish subsidies and concessions

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Update, search and make accessible
- [8] Minimise need for applications
- VERDICT → The strongest RTI system answers routine questions before they become disputes.
- ANSWER USE → Use for reform, capacity and anti-corruption answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The strongest RTI system answers routine questions before they become disputes.

03

STAGE 03

SECTIONS 6 AND 7 REQUEST CLOCK

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The strongest RTI system answers routine questions before they become disputes.

03

STAGE 03 SECTIONS 6 AND 7 REQUEST CLOCK

SECTIONS 6 AND 7 REQUEST CLOCK

CENTRAL FOCUS

4. SECTIONS 6 AND 7 REQUEST CLOCK

[1] FILE WRITTEN OR ELECTRONIC REQUEST

[2] USE ENGLISH, HINDI OR LOCAL OFFICIAL LANGUAGE

[3] GIVE CONTACT DETAIL, NOT REASONS

[4] TRANSFER UNDER SECTION 6(3)

[5] ORDINARY DECISION

CENTRAL FOCUS

4. Sections 6 and 7 request clock

[1] File written or electronic request

[2] Use English, Hindi or local official language

[3] Give contact detail, not reasons

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 4. Sections 6 and 7 request clock
- [1] File written or electronic request
- [2] Use English, Hindi or local official language

MECHANISM

- [3] Give contact detail, not reasons
- [4] Transfer under Section 6(3)
- [5] Ordinary decision: thirty days
- [6] Life or liberty: forty-eight hours

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Silence becomes deemed refusal
- [8] Delay makes information free
- VERDICT → Access is meaningful only when procedure is simple, assisted and time-bound.
- ANSWER USE → Use for application and timeline close-option questions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Access is meaningful only when procedure is simple, assisted and time-bound.

04

STAGE 04 SECTION 8 EXEMPTION AND BALANCE

SECTION 8 EXEMPTION AND BALANCE

CENTRAL FOCUS

5. SECTION 8 EXEMPTION AND BALANCE

[1] NAME EXACT EXEMPTION CLAUSE

[2] IDENTIFY PROTECTED INTEREST

[3] SPECIFY LIKELY DISCLOSURE HARM

[4] REJECT GENERIC CONFIDENTIALITY

[5] TEST SECTION 8(2) PUBLIC INTEREST

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 5. Section 8 exemption and balance
- [1] Name exact exemption clause
- [2] Identify protected interest

MECHANISM

- [3] Specify likely disclosure harm
- [4] Reject generic confidentiality
- [5] Test Section 8(2) public interest
- [6] Consider twenty-year rule

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Record clause-linked reasons
- [8] Preserve appeal and review
- VERDICT → A protected interest requires a reasoned harm analysis, not a secrecy label.
- ANSWER USE → Use for exemptions, OSA and public-interest questions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → A protected interest requires a reasoned harm analysis, not a secrecy label.

05

STAGE 05 SEVERABILITY AND THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE

SEVERABILITY AND THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE

CENTRAL FOCUS

6. SEVERABILITY AND THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE

[1] IDENTIFY PROTECTED SEGMENT

[2] TEST REASONABLE SEPARATION

[3] RELEASE NON-EXEMPT REMAINDER

[4] NOTIFY REASONS AND REVIEW RIGHTS

[5] NOTIFY AFFECTED THIRD PARTY

CENTRAL FOCUS

6. Severability and third-party procedure

[1] Identify protected segment

[2] Test reasonable separation

[3] Release non-exempt remainder

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 6. Severability and third-party procedure
- [1] Identify protected segment
- [2] Test reasonable separation

MECHANISM

- [3] Release non-exempt remainder
- [4] Notify reasons and review rights
- [5] Notify affected third party
- [6] Receive timely representation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] PIO decides independently
- [8] Notify both sides of appeal
- VERDICT → Redaction narrows secrecy; consultation improves fairness without creating a veto.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Sections 10 and 11.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Redaction narrows secrecy; consultation improves fairness without creating a veto.

06

STAGE 06 APPEAL, BURDEN, REMEDY AND PENALTY

APPEAL, BURDEN, REMEDY AND PENALTY

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. APPEAL, BURDEN, REMEDY AND PENALTY

[1] PIO GIVES DECISION OR DEFAULTS

[2] FIRST APPEAL WITHIN AUTHORITY

[3] SECOND APPEAL TO COMMISSION

[4] PIO BEARS DENIAL BURDEN

[5] COMMISSION MAY ORDER ACCESS

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Appeal, burden, remedy and penalty

[1] PIO gives decision or defaults

[2] First appeal within authority

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Appeal, burden, remedy and penalty
- [1] PIO gives decision or defaults
- [2] First appeal within authority

MECHANISM

- [3] Second appeal to Commission
- [4] PIO bears denial burden
- [5] Commission may order access
- [6] Commission may require system reform

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Section 20 penalty is conditional
- [8] Persistent default may trigger discipline
- VERDICT → RTI accountability joins access, justification, correction and personal consequence.
- ANSWER USE → Use for 2018 Q2(b) and enforcement reform.

07

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Appeal, burden, remedy and penalty
- [1] PIO gives decision or defaults
- [2] First appeal within authority

MECHANISM

- [3] Second appeal to Commission
- [4] PIO bears denial burden
- [5] Commission may order access
- [6] Commission may require system reform

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Section 20 penalty is conditional
- [8] Persistent default may trigger discipline
- VERDICT → RTI accountability joins access, justification, correction and personal consequence.
- ANSWER USE → Use for 2018 Q2(b) and enforcement reform.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → RTI accountability joins access, justification, correction and personal consequence.

08

STAGE 07

SECTION 24 SPECIAL BOUNDARY

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CENTRAL FOCUS

8. SECTION 24 SPECIAL BOUNDARY

[1] CHECK NOTIFIED SECURITY ORGANISATION

[2] GENERAL EXCLUSION APPLIES

[3] TEST CORRUPTION ALLEGATION

[4] TEST HUMAN-RIGHTS ALLEGATION

[5] CORRUPTION ROUTE REMAINS OPEN

8. Section 24 special boundary

[1] Check notified security organisation

[2] General exclusion applies

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Section 24 special boundary
- [1] Check notified security organisation
- [2] General exclusion applies

MECHANISM

- [3] Test corruption allegation
- [4] Test human-rights allegation
- [5] Corruption route remains open
- [6] Human-rights route needs approval

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Apply special forty-five-day period
- [8] Protect genuine operational harm
- VERDICT → Security-organisation exclusion is broad but not absolute.
- ANSWER USE → Use for statutory traps and balanced national-security answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Security-organisation exclusion is broad but not absolute.

09

STAGE 08

RTI AMENDMENT 2019 INSTITUTIONAL MAP

RTI AMENDMENT 2019 INSTITUTIONAL MAP

CENTRAL FOCUS

9. RTI AMENDMENT 2019 INSTITUTIONAL MAP

[1] PRE-2019 TENURE FIXED IN ACT

[2] PRE-2019 SALARY LINKS FIXED IN ACT

[3] 2019 SHIFTS DETAIL TO CENTRAL RULES

[4] CHANGE COVERS CENTRAL COMMISSIONS

[5] CHANGE ALSO COVERS STATE COMMISSIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[3] 2019 shifts detail to Central rules	[7] Independence concern is structural
9. RTI Amendment 2019 institutional map	[4] Change covers Central Commissions	[8] Actual interference is not proved
[1] Pre-2019 tenure fixed in Act	[5] Change also covers State Commissions	VERDICT → State the design risk precisely without claiming that RTI rights were abolished.
[2] Pre-2019 salary links fixed in Act	[6] Rules prescribe three-year term	ANSWER USE → Use for institutional-independence evaluation.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 9. RTI Amendment 2019 institutional map
- [1] Pre-2019 tenure fixed in Act
- [2] Pre-2019 salary links fixed in Act

MECHANISM

- [3] 2019 shifts detail to Central rules
- [4] Change covers Central Commissions
- [5] Change also covers State Commissions
- [6] Rules prescribe three-year term

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Independence concern is structural
- [8] Actual interference is not proved
- VERDICT → State the design risk precisely without claiming that RTI rights were abolished.
- ANSWER USE → Use for institutional-independence evaluation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → State the design risk precisely without claiming that RTI rights were abolished.

STAGE 09

OSA AND RTI INTERFACE

OSA AND RTI INTERFACE

CENTRAL FOCUS

10. OSA AND RTI INTERFACE

[1] OSA 1923 REMAINS IN FORCE

[2] ARC RECOMMENDED REPEAL AND RELOCATION

[3] RECOMMENDATION IS NOT ENACTED LAW

[4] RTI SECTION 22 OVERRIDES INCONSISTENCY

[5] SECTION 8 PROTECTS GENUINE INTERESTS

CENTRAL FOCUS

10. OSA and RTI interface

[1] OSA 1923 remains in force

[2] ARC recommended repeal and relocation

[3] Recommendation is not enacted law

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. OSA and RTI interface
- [1] OSA 1923 remains in force
- [2] ARC recommended repeal and relocation

MECHANISM

- [3] Recommendation is not enacted law
- [4] RTI Section 22 overrides inconsistency
- [5] Section 8 protects genuine interests
- [6] Section 8(2) weighs public interest

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Section 10 narrows withholding
- [8] Reasoned review replaces blanket label
- VERDICT → Official secrecy survives, but it cannot bypass the RTI Act's own decision architecture.
- ANSWER USE → Use for the 2019 direct PYQ.

TRANSPARENCY, RTI AND INFORMATION SHARING • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 5791-9025 of 11920 • continues below

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. OSA and RTI interface
- [1] OSA 1923 remains in force
- [2] ARC recommended repeal and relocation

MECHANISM

- [3] Recommendation is not enacted law
- [4] RTI Section 22 overrides inconsistency
- [5] Section 8 protects genuine interests
- [6] Section 8(2) weighs public interest

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Section 10 narrows withholding
- [8] Reasoned review replaces blanket label
- VERDICT → Official secrecy survives, but it cannot bypass the RTI Act's own decision architecture.
- ANSWER USE → Use for the 2019 direct PYQ.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Official secrecy survives, but it cannot bypass the RTI Act's own decision architecture.

10

STAGE 10

PRIVACY AFTER PUTTASWAMY AND DPDP

PRIVACY AFTER PUTTASWAMY AND DPDP

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. PRIVACY AFTER PUTTASWAMY AND DPDP

[1] PRIVACY PROTECTS DIGNITY AND AUTONOMY

[2] STATE ACTION NEEDS LEGALITY

[3] AIM AND PROPORTIONALITY MATTER

[4] SAFEGUARDS AND REMEDY MATTER

[5] SECTION 44(3) COMMENCED 13 NOV 2025

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. Privacy after Puttaswamy and DPDP

[1] Privacy protects dignity and autonomy

[2] State action needs legality

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. Privacy after Puttaswamy and DPDP
- [1] Privacy protects dignity and autonomy
- [2] State action needs legality

MECHANISM

- [3] Aim and proportionality matter
- [4] Safeguards and remedy matter
- [5] Section 44(3) commenced 13 Nov 2025
- [6] RTI 8(1)(j) text was substituted

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Sections 8(2), 10 and 11 remain
- [8] Sec 6(9): 13 Nov 2026; core: 13 May 2027
- VERDICT → Use current text and acknowledge unresolved interaction instead of reviving deleted wording.
- ANSWER USE → Use for privacy-transparency and current-law answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Use current text and acknowledge unresolved interaction instead of reviving deleted wording.

11

STAGE 11

ETHICAL DIGITAL INFORMATION-SHARING DESIGN

ETHICAL DIGITAL INFORMATION-SHARING DESIGN

CENTRAL FOCUS

12. ETHICAL DIGITAL INFORMATION-SHARING DESIGN

[1] ESTABLISH LAWFUL AUTHORITY

[2] DEFINE SPECIFIC PURPOSE

[3] SHARE MINIMUM NECESSARY FIELDS

[4] VERIFY ACCURACY AND PROVENANCE

[5] CONTROL ACCESS AND RETENTION

CENTRAL FOCUS

12. Ethical digital information-sharing design

[1] Establish lawful authority

[2] Define specific purpose

[3] Share minimum necessary fields

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 12. Ethical digital information-sharing design
- [1] Establish lawful authority
- [2] Define specific purpose

MECHANISM

- [3] Share minimum necessary fields
- [4] Verify accuracy and provenance
- [5] Control access and retention
- [6] Publish only safe aggregates

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Enable correction and appeal
- [8] Audit necessity, use and outcomes
- VERDICT → An accountable State should be transparent about power without making citizens needlessly transparent.
- ANSWER USE → Use for databases, open data and twenty-mark design questions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → An accountable State should be transparent about power without making citizens needlessly transparent.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. TRANSPARENCY AS AN INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE OF POWER

2. FROM PROACTIVE DISCLOSURE TO INFORMATION STEWARDSHIP

3. EXEMPTION REASONING

CLASS, HARM, BALANCE AND NARROWNESS

4. SEVERABILITY, MOSAIC RISK AND CALIBRATED ACCESS

5. THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE AND MULTI-PARTY FAIRNESS

6. ENFORCEMENT QUALITY AND INSTITUTIONAL INDEPENDENCE

OPTIONAL ETHICAL DEPTH

- 1. Transparency as an information architecture of power
- 2. From proactive disclosure to information stewardship
- 3. Exemption reasoning: class, harm, balance and narrowness
- 4. Severability, mosaic risk and calibrated access

ADVANCED LIMIT / TRADE-OFF

- 5. Third-party procedure and multi-party fairness
- 6. Enforcement quality and institutional independence
- 7. Official Secrets Act: conflict of norms and administrative culture
- 8. Privacy after Puttaswamy and the changed Section 8(1)(j)

ADMINISTRATIVE APPLICATION

- 9. Information sharing, interoperability and open-government limits
- 10. Advanced answer synthesis, reforms and source boundaries
- identify likely recurring information demands when a programme is created;
- structure records to answer them;

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.